

Bedtime Tales

The Chalk Garden



KIDS BOOK VIDEOS



Lily loved drawing with chalk on the sidewalk outside her cottage at the edge of Willowmere Wood. One sunny morning, she drew a garden — flowers, a butterfly, and a little bird. She felt happy.

Then something strange happened: the chalk butterfly fluttered its wings. Flap, flap. Lily felt amazed.



"Did you just move?" she whispered.

The butterfly lifted off the sidewalk, flew one small loop, and landed right back on its chalk flower.



Delighted, Lily drew a chalk sun, and it glowed warmly. She drew chalk raindrops, and they fell softly on the chalk flowers — plip, plip, plip — making them sway.

"My garden is alive," breathed Lily. "Alive, alive, alive," she whispered. That was three times she whispered it, and she felt joyful.



She drew a chalk rabbit, and it hopped twice — hop, hop. She drew a chalk turtle, and it took one slow step. Step. Lily giggled. Then she noticed something: the chalk bird looked sad, its chalk beak drooping.



"What's wrong, little bird?" asked Lily, worried.

The bird hopped toward the edge of the sidewalk and looked at the real sky.



"Oh," said Lily softly. "You want a friend."

She drew another bird beside it — a friend bird. The two chalk birds chirped — chirp, chirp — and hopped together, happy now. A warm feeling spread through Lily. She had helped.



As the sun went down, the chalk animals grew still. The butterfly folded its wings, the rabbit curled up, and the two birds tucked their heads.

"Goodnight, garden," Lily whispered. "Goodnight, goodnight, goodnight." That was three times she whispered it, and she felt sleepy.



The chalk glowed softly in the moonlight.



Dream of gardens that wake when you draw them.



Sleep now, little Lily.

Sleep now, little Lily.

The End

